Manual Chapter : Using Via Headers to Acquire Information About Intermediate Routers

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Using Via Headers to Acquire Information About Intermediate Routers

Overview: Using Via headers

Via headers provide useful information about intermediate routers that can be used in network analysis and troubleshooting.

Task summary for identifying intermediate information with Via headers

Perform these tasks to identify intermediate information with Via headers.

Identifying information about intermediate proxies with Via headers

The BIG-IP system can include Via headers (configured in an HTTP profile) in a request, a response, or both, to identify information, such as protocols and names, for intermediate proxies that forward messages.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic** › **Profiles** › **Services** › **HTTP** .
   The HTTP profile list screen opens.
2. Click the name of a user-defined profile.
3. Select the **Custom** check box.
4. In the **Send Proxy Via Header In Request** list, do one of the following:
   - Select the **Preserve** option to include the Via header in the client request to the origin web server.
   - Select the **Append** option, and then type a string in the **Send Proxy Via Header Host Name** field, which is appended as a comment when sending a Via header in a request to an origin web server.
5. In the **Send Proxy Via Header In Response** list, do one of the following:
   - Select the **Preserve** option to include the Via header in the client response to the client.
   - Select the **Append** option, and then type a string in the **Send Proxy Via Header Host Name** field, which is appended as a comment when sending a Via header in a response to a client.
6. Click **Finished**.

The BIG-IP system is configured to use Via headers to identify protocols and intermediate proxies that forward messages.

Removing Via headers from requests and responses

Via headers are configured in an HTTP profile for requests or responses.

You can remove Via headers from requests and responses if you no longer require them to identify information about intermediate proxies.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic** › **Profiles** › **Services** › **HTTP** .
   The HTTP profile list screen opens.

2. Click the name of a user-defined profile.
3. Select the **Custom** check box.
4. In the **Send Proxy Via Header In Request** list, select **Remove.**
5. In the **Send Proxy Via Header In Response** list, select **Remove.**
6. Click **Finished.**

The BIG-IP system removes Via headers, as configured, for requests and responses.

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